Oil & Gas

13 March 2026

Price and volume risk at the peak

The global crude market has entered a phase of heightened volatility in last 2 weeks crossing $100/bbl as we write, driven primarily by 1) destruction of oil & gas assets amid West Asia War triggered a strong risk premium in prices, and 2) tightening supply dynamics owing to closure of Strait of Hormuz. Global rig activity has also increased (3.5% MoM/8.3% YoY) owing to higher hydrocarbon prices. Meanwhile, elevated tanker freight rates and insurance premiums for vessels transiting high-risk zones have raised the cost of procurement significantly. While upstream companies benefit from stronger realizations, risk of implementation of windfall tax looms overhead. GRMs have seen a sharp uptick to over ~$20/bbl in recent days as petrol and diesel cracks hovering near $40/bbl and $80/bbl. Though at current prices, marketing losses on petrol/diesel rose to Rs20/45 per ltr, leading to the industry's daily loss of Rs20 bn (Rs16.5 bn from diesel and Rs3.5 bn from petrol). Spot LNG price also moved up over 50% within a month on the back of stoppage of supply from the one of the largest producing country Qatar. This resulted in nearly 25% cut in India's gas supply which would impact gas utility companies negatively. Though we believe near term volatility would impact the valuation but keep RIL, PLNG, Deep Industries, and Gulf Oil as our preferred picks for the long term.

Global/US Rig count, Spot LNG and GRM rose while marketing and petchem margin fell: The global rig count increased by 144 rigs YoY/64 rigs MoM to 1,885 in Feb'26, despite lower US rig count (down 39 rigs YoY). Though GRM averaged at $6.8/bbl in Feb'26, it is currently hovering near $15-20/bbl owing to sharp rise in light and middle distillates cracks. Refinery operations have peaked in India while ATF/Petrol tankers headed towards Western countries now have shifted its path towards Asian countries. Spot LNG followed the similar trend and went up over $15-16/mmbtu recently after seeing an average of $10.9/mmbtu in Feb'26. Polymer margins declined across products in Feb'26 after seeing a rise in Jan'26. Diesel marketing margin saw a sharp reduction, down 57% MoM/-40% YoY to Rs3.5/ltr while Petrol margin declined 10% MoM but rose 26% YoY to Rs11.5/ltr in Feb'26. However, at current prices, marketing losses on petrol/diesel rose to Rs20/45 per ltr, leading to the industry's daily loss of Rs20 bn (Rs16.5 bn from diesel and Rs3.5 bn from petrol).

Surge in Tanker rates: Oil tanker rates have surged to multi-year highs in early 2026, driven by intense geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, particularly following US-Iran conflicts, which have severely restricted traffic in the Strait of Hormuz. Tanker rates have surged, with VLCC rates more than doubling to over $423,000 per day (Middle East-China route) in early March 2026, driven by severe disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and soaring insurance war-risk premiums. A massive, strategic buying spree by South Korea's Sinokor Shipping Group, which now controls a significant portion of the non-sanctioned fleet, has tightened supply. Some of the Vessels are avoiding high-risk areas, requiring longer routes such as around the Cape of Good Hope, which adds 15-20 days and limits vessel availability. Surging tanker rates pushed US crude shippers to use small vessels, 3 Aframax tanker (7 lakh bbls each) carries close to what 1 VLCC tanker can carry. Several Aframax vessels have recently been booked to carry crude from the Gulf Coast to Singapore, with loading to be done in mid-March as per Bloomberg.

MONTHLY UPDATE

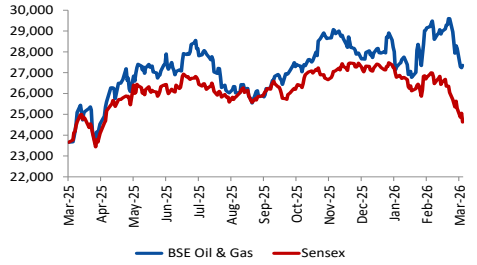
Industry	Oil & Gas

Sector Recommendations

Company	Mkt Cap (Rs bn)	TP (Rs)	Rating
RELIANCE	18,808	1,700	BUY
DEEPIND	22	693	BUY
GOLI	50	1,660	BUY
MGL	104	1,374	BUY
GUJGAS	265	447	HOLD
IGL	227	226	BUY
GAIL	1,003	176	HOLD
PLNG	445	342	BUY

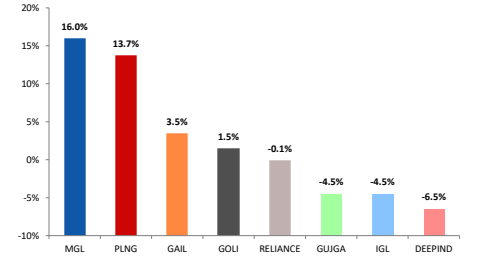
Source: BSE, Systematix Research

BSE Oil & Gas v/s Sensex



Source: BSE, Systematix Research

Coverage - Stock Performance (Feb'26)



Source: BSE, Systematix Research

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Investors are advised to refer disclosures made at the end of the research report.

Petroleum product consumption (Feb'26): Total demand stood at 20.2 MMT (+5.8% YoY / -3.8% MoM). YoY growth was driven by HSD, MS, and LPG, indicating resilient industrial and mobility demand, while the sequential decline was led by diesel, ATF, LPG, and industrial fuels. LPG rose 9.7% YoY (-7% MoM) on steady household demand, MS grew 6.1% YoY (-4% MoM) supported by strong personal mobility, and HSD fell 4.1% MoM due to lower freight movement post-festive.

Russian purchase is set to increase: About 6 days ago, the US issued a 30-day waiver for India to accept Russian oil already at sea so as to stabilise global supply during the Iran conflict. According to Bloomberg, India bought nearly 30mn barrels of unsold Russian crude following the 30-day US waiver. Earlier, India had reduced purchases of Russian oil, partly replacing them with crude from Saudi Arabia and Iraq. Recently Indian companies ramped up its import from Russia. The cargoes included multiple Russian grades such as Urals, ESPO, and Varandey. Notably, these barrels were offered at premiums of $2–$8/bbl to London Dated Brent, a sharp reversal from earlier months when Russian crude traded at discounts to global benchmarks.

Exhibit 1: Valuation snapshot

Companies	CMP	Reco	TP	P/E			EV/EBITDA			P/BV (Rs)			RoE (%)		
	(Rs)		(Rs)	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Reliance Industries Ltd	1,390	BUY	1,700	25.1	22.8	20.8	10.8	10.0	9.1	2.1	1.9	1.8	8.9	8.4	8.5
GAIL India Ltd	153	HOLD	176	14.6	11.4	10.5	10.1	8.1	7.3	1.5	1.4	1.3	10.1	12.1	12.3
Petronet LNG	297	BUY	342	11.4	10.2	9.6	6.3	5.7	5.4	2.1	1.9	1.7	18.2	18.3	17.6
Gujarat Gas Ltd	385	HOLD	447	21.2	20.0	18.8	12.8	11.9	10.7	2.9	2.7	2.4	13.6	13.4	12.6
Indraprastha Gas Ltd	162	BUY	226	14.6	11.9	10.9	9.3	7.2	6.4	2.2	1.9	1.7	15.0	16.3	15.8
Mahanagar Gas	1,049	BUY	1,374	10.7	11.0	10.7	5.4	5.0	4.4	1.6	1.5	1.4	15.0	13.5	12.8
Gulf Oil Lubricants India	1,012	BUY	1,660	14.4	11.5	10.3	7.0	5.5	4.3	3.1	2.9	2.6	22.7	26.2	26.5
Deep Industries	340	BUY	693	8.3	7.0	5.9	6.5	5.8	4.4	1.3	1.1	1.0	14.8	15.3	15.6

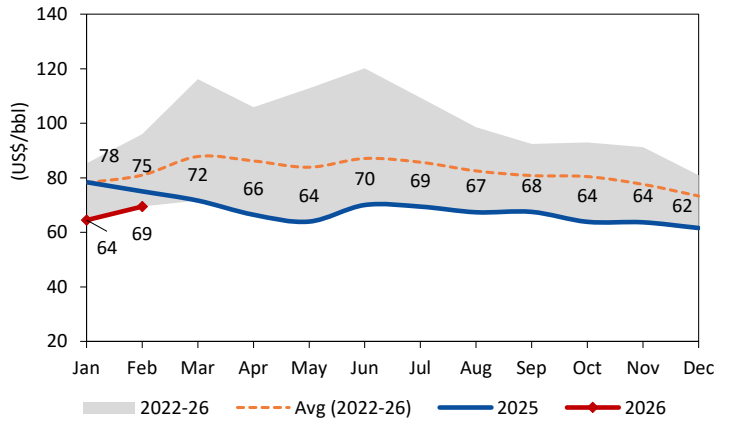
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 2: Stock performance over a decade

Name	CMP (Rs)	% Price Change Week	% Price Change 1 Month	% Price Change 3 Months	% Price Change 6 Months	% Price Change 1 Yr	% Price Change YTD	% Price Change 5 Yr	% Price Change 10 Yr
Reliance Industries Ltd	1,390	0.1	(4.1)	(10.7)	(0.4)	10.6	(11.5)	42.7	504.1
GAIL India Ltd	153	(2.7)	(6.8)	(10.6)	(14.6)	(4.2)	(11.4)	55.9	137.2
Petronet LNG Ltd	297	1.3	(0.1)	10.4	6.8	4.1	4.5	22.7	138.6
Gujarat Gas Ltd	385	(3.0)	(9.4)	(2.6)	(10.6)	(0.0)	(6.5)	(25.7)	285.0
Indraprastha Gas Ltd	162	1.1	(4.5)	(13.3)	(24.6)	(14.0)	(16.8)	(36.3)	209.6
Mahanagar Gas Ltd	1,049	(4.4)	(9.1)	(6.7)	(19.5)	(19.3)	(7.7)	(13.2)	149.2
Gulf Oil Lubricants India Ltd	1,012	(1.0)	(12.6)	(12.7)	(22.2)	(16.5)	(15.7)	37.9	112.8
Deep Industries	340	(3.4)	(16.8)	(23.0)	(36.3)	(25.8)	(26.3)	1,697.1	1,697.1
Indian Oil Corp Ltd	160	(6.6)	(10.0)	(2.1)	12.4	27.9	(3.7)	137.2	149.6
Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd	326	(9.4)	(13.6)	(10.6)	2.6	22.6	(15.0)	42.7	143.4
Hindustan Petroleum Corp Ltd	384	(8.2)	(15.1)	(16.5)	(3.7)	17.3	(23.1)	138.7	258.6
Chennai Petroleum Corp Ltd	945	(4.7)	5.3	1.9	28.6	70.9	13.0	745.2	373.9
Mangalore Refinery & Petrochemicals Ltd	191	(2.5)	0.1	28.5	51.3	70.7	25.9	356.9	231.2
Oil & Natural Gas Corp Ltd	270	(2.2)	(2.2)	13.6	15.9	20.5	12.5	135.0	94.7
Oil India Ltd	479	0.1	1.0	18.6	20.3	30.7	13.0	445.2	364.0
Gujarat State Petronet Ltd	278	(4.0)	(10.3)	(3.8)	(9.7)	1.5	(9.1)	0.1	120.8
Adani Total Gas Ltd	609	26.0	13.6	2.6	0.6	1.4	7.5	(17.5)	705.6
BSE OIL & GAS	**27,496**	**(2.8)**	**(5.6)**	**(1.7)**	**4.8**	**15.9**	**(4.2)**	**73.0**	**212.9**
NSE Nifty 50 Index	**23,633**	**(4.6)**	**(8.4)**	**(9.3)**	**(5.9)**	**5.2**	**(9.6)**	**57.2**	**213.5**

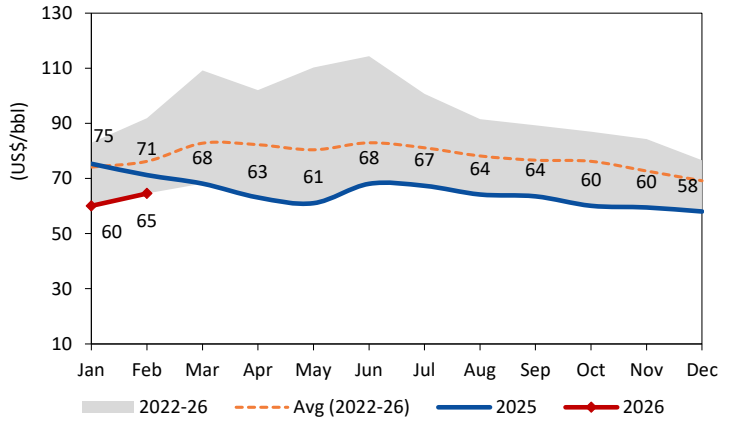
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 3: Brent up 8% MoM, due to geopolitical uncertainties



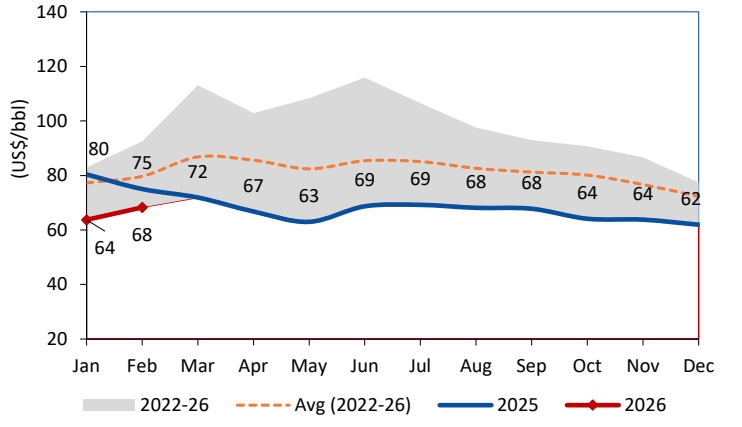
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 4: … similarly WTI oil price up 7.5% MoM/-9.3% YoY



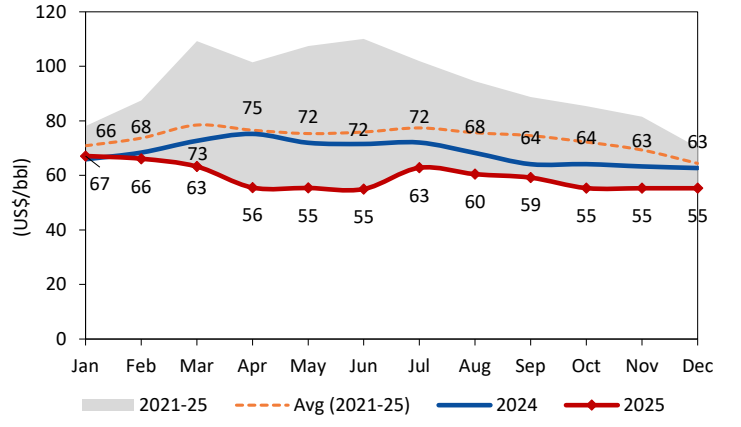
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 5: Price of Dubai oil rose 7.2% MoM/-9% YoY



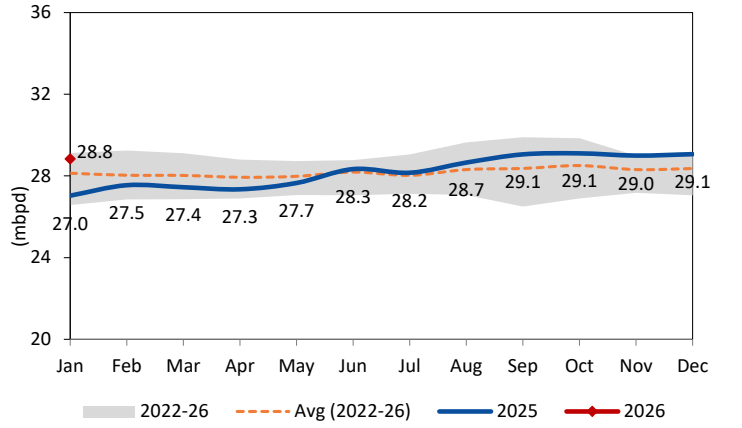
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 6: Maya crude price in CY25, remained below CY24 level



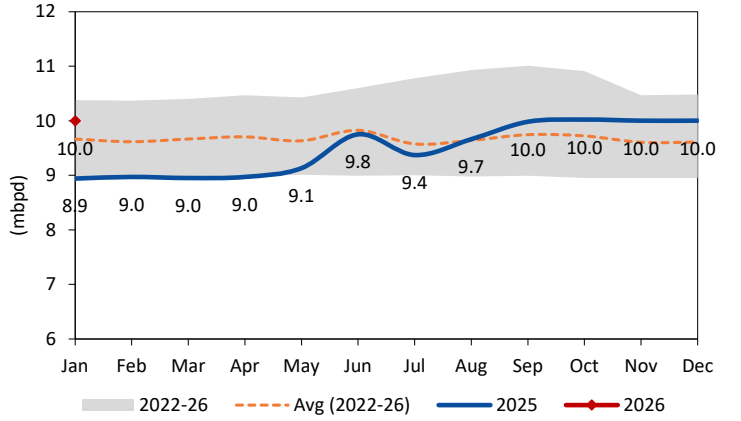
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 7: OPEC: Crude production flattish MoM



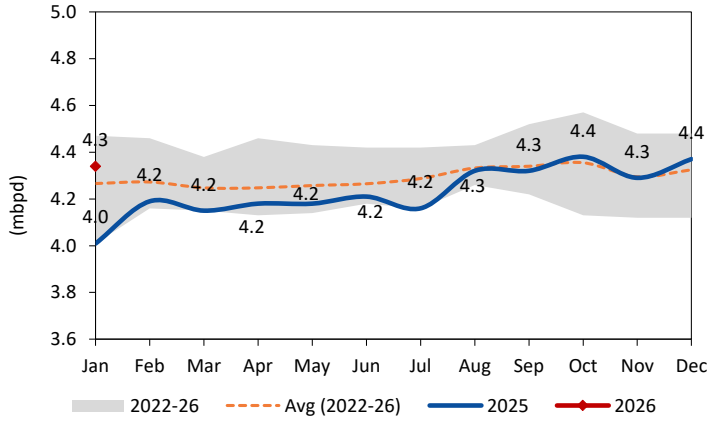
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 8: Saudi's Jan production flattish QoQ, up 12% YoY



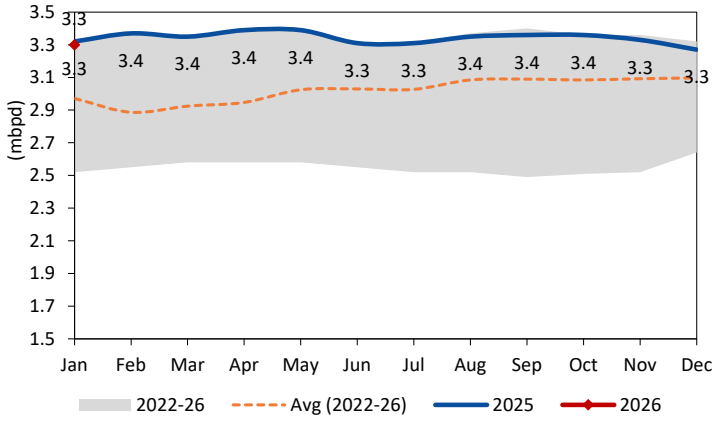
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 9: Iraq's oil production rose 6% YoY/down 3% MoM



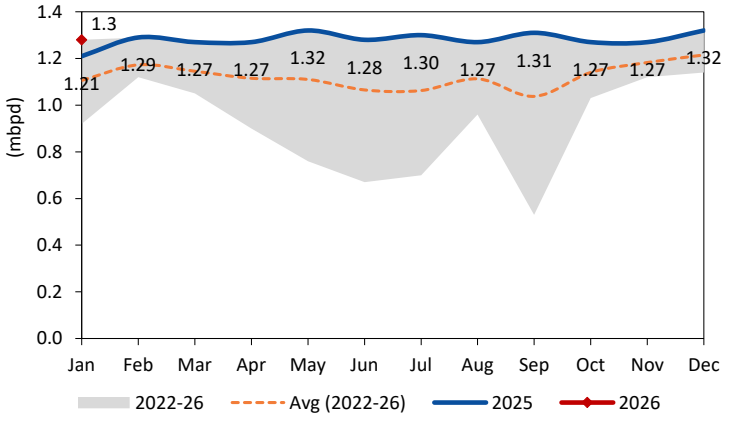
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 10: Iran average production flattish in FY26YTD



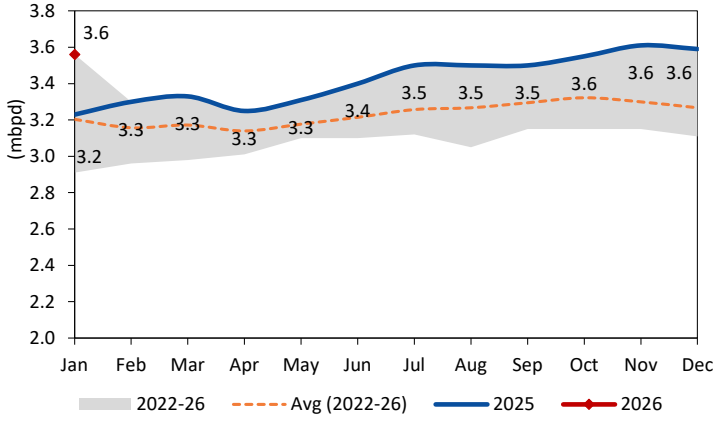
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 11: Libya oil production down 3% MoM/up 5.8% YoY



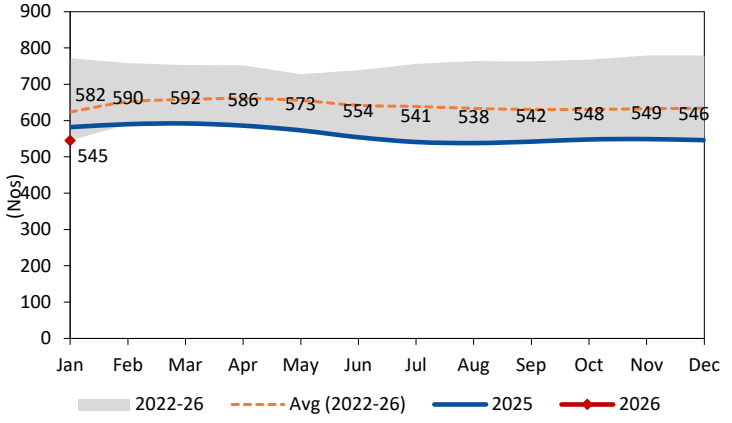
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 12: UAE oil production flattish MoM/up 10.2% YoY



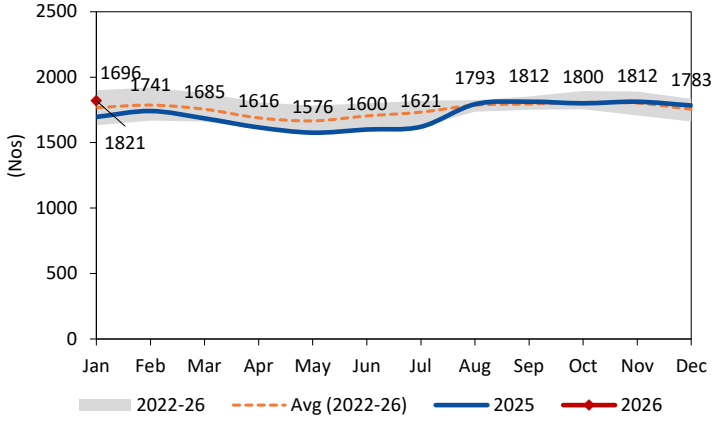
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 13: US rig count up MoM/down YoY by +6/-39 rigs respc.



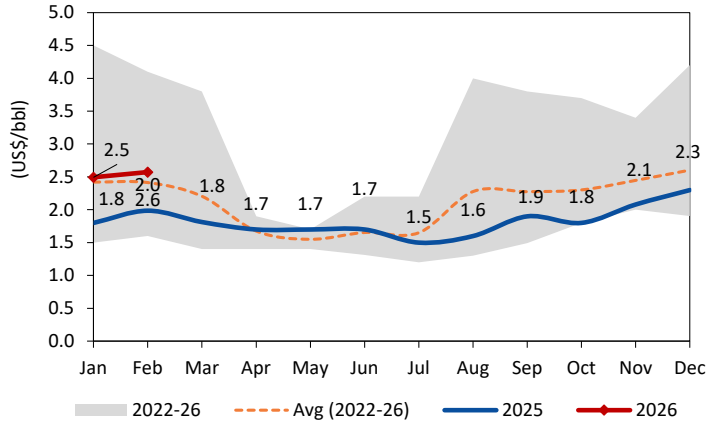
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 14: Global rigs rose 4% MoM/+8% YoY (Highest in last 3yrs)



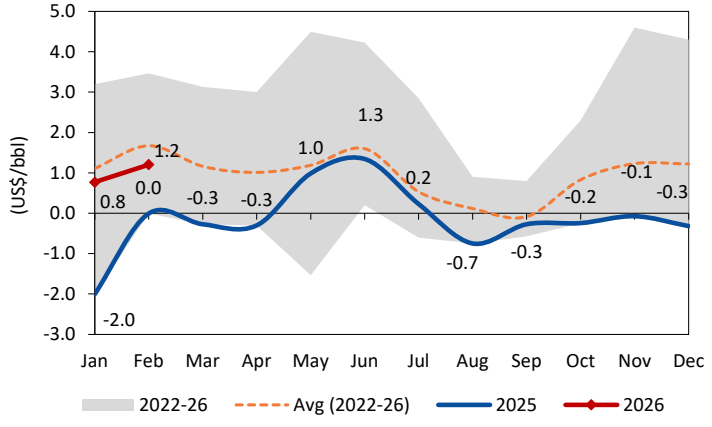
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 15: Arab Light-Arab Heavy spread rose 3.1% YoY



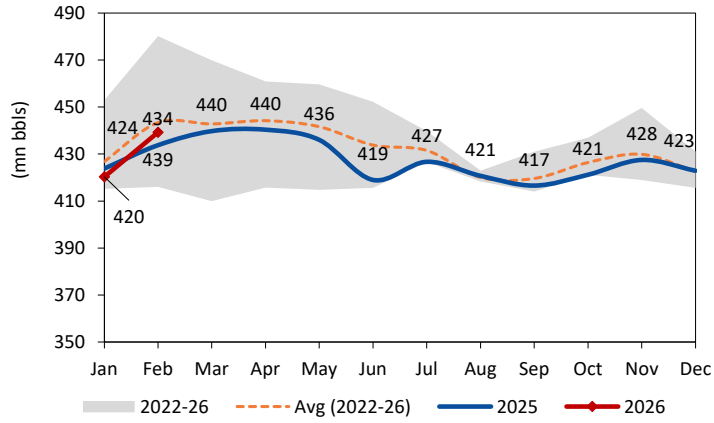
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 16: Brent-Dubai differential remains volatile



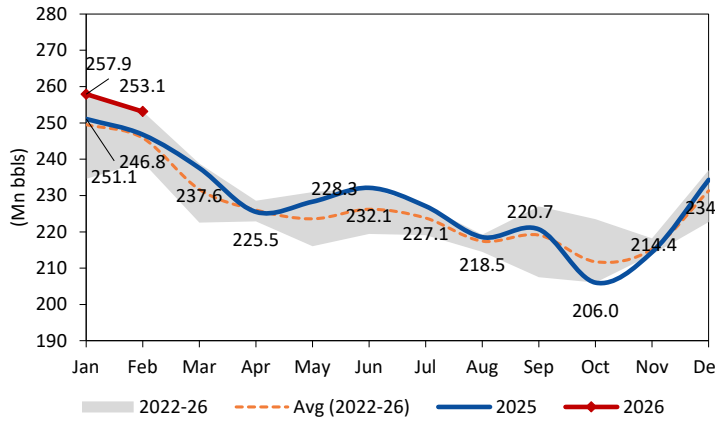
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 17: US crude oil inventory up 4.5% MoM/1.3% YoY



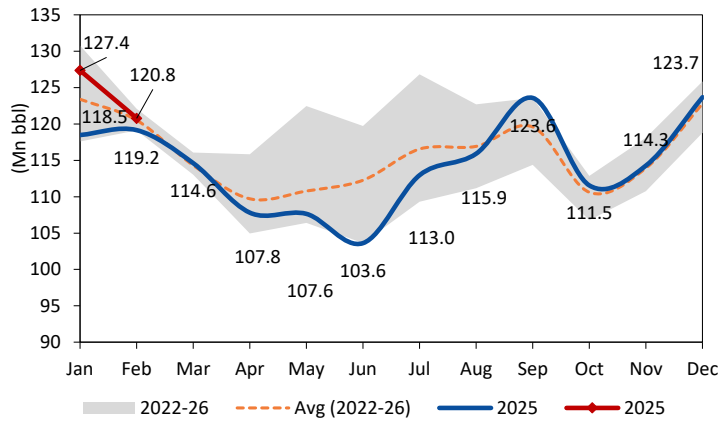
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 18: US gasoline inventory dips further by 1.8% MoM



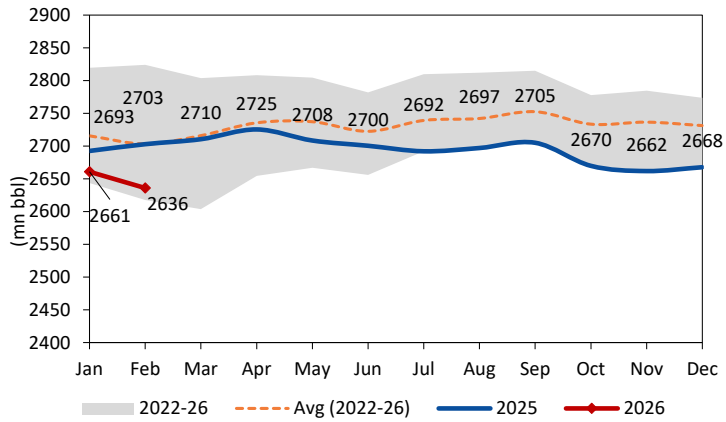
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 19: US distillates inventory jumps 1.4% YoY/-5.2% MoM



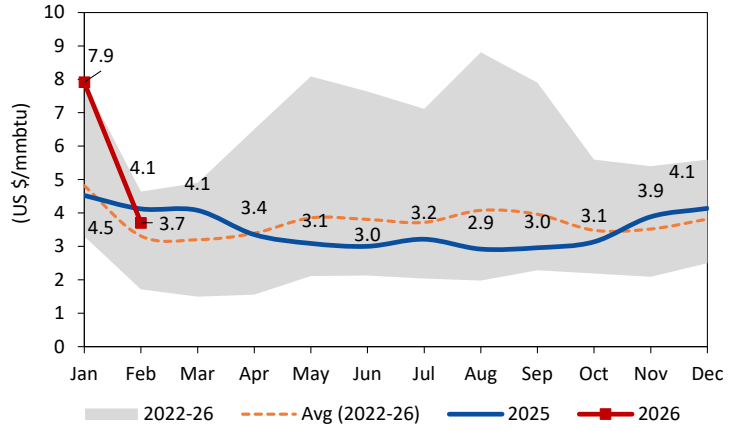
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 20: OECD oil inventory flattish, mere up 0.9% MoM



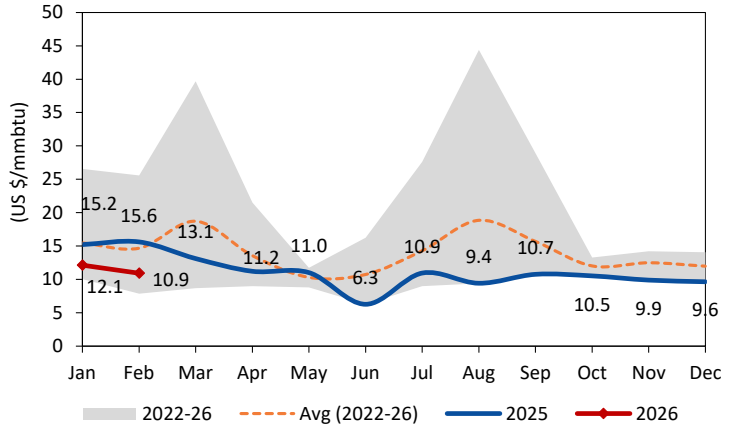
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 21: Henry-Hub gas price corrected 53.2% MoM



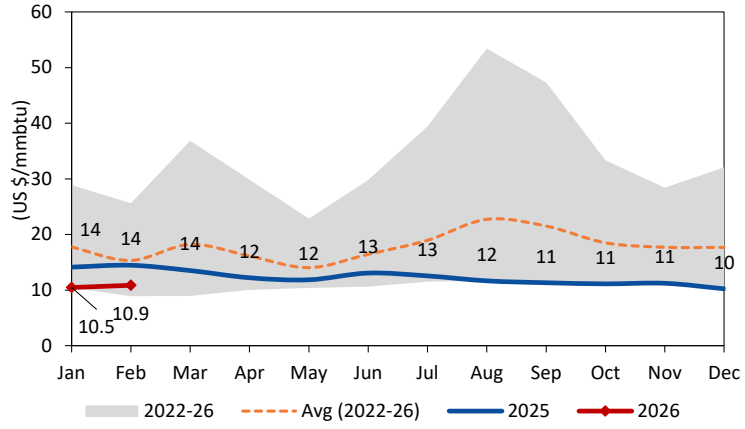
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 22: NBP price down 10% MoM/-2.4% in FY26



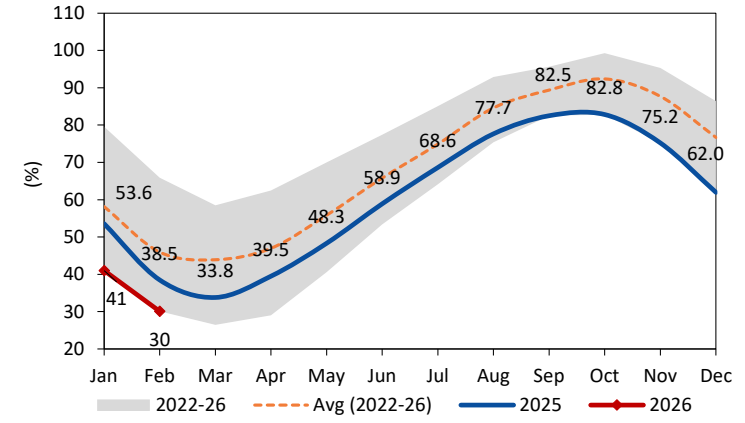
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 23: Japan Korea LNG 3.9% MoM/-24.9% YoY



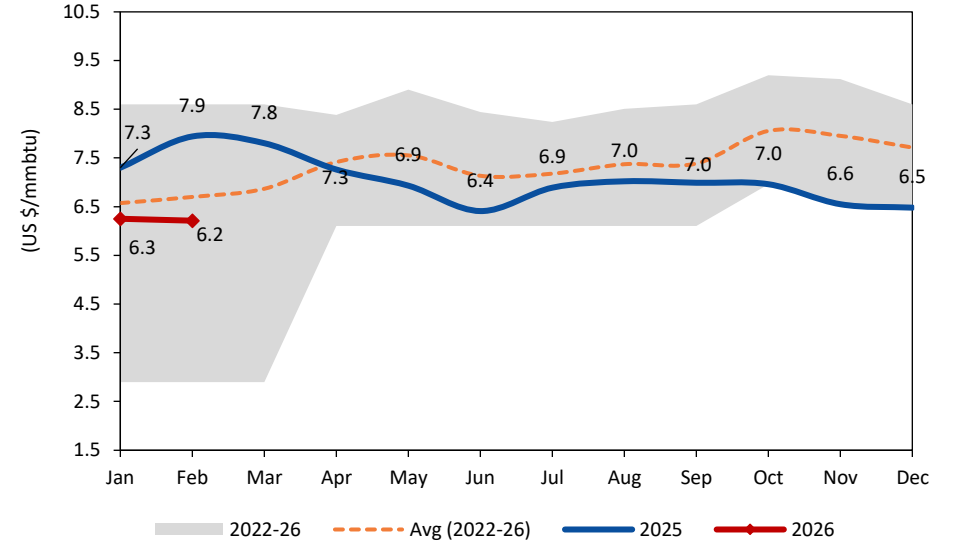
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 24: European Gas storage down to 30% from 83% in Nov'25



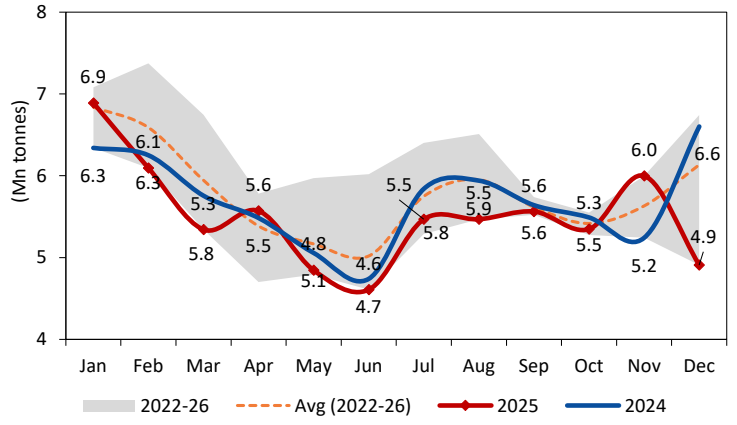
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 25: Domestic gas price below threshold for 4th consecutive month



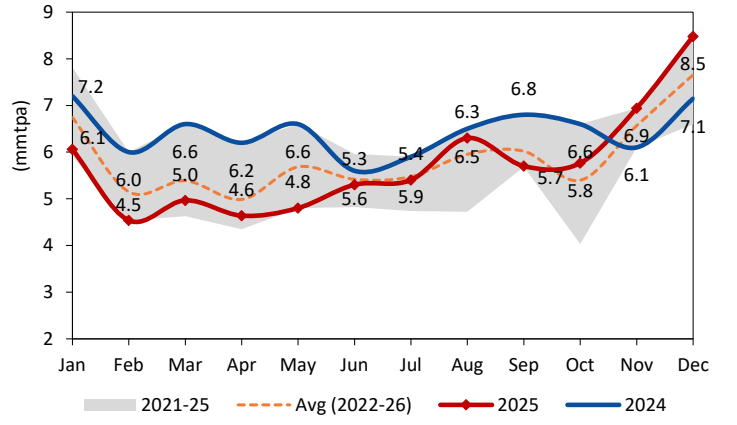
Source: Systematix Research (Prices for fields not under nomination)

Exhibit 26: Japan LNG import down 18.2% MoM to 6.8mt



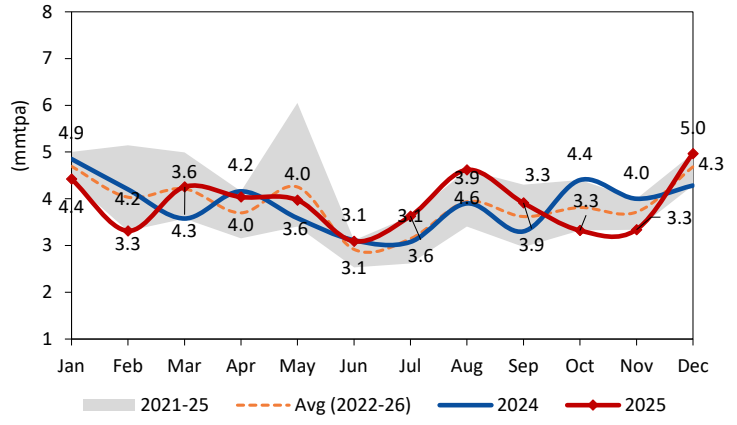
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 27: China LNG import rises 22.2% MoM/83% FY26-YTD



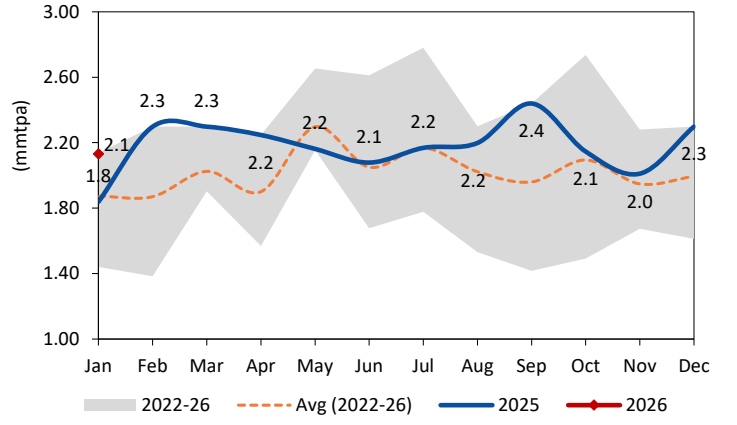
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 28: Korea LNG import volume down 12% MoM



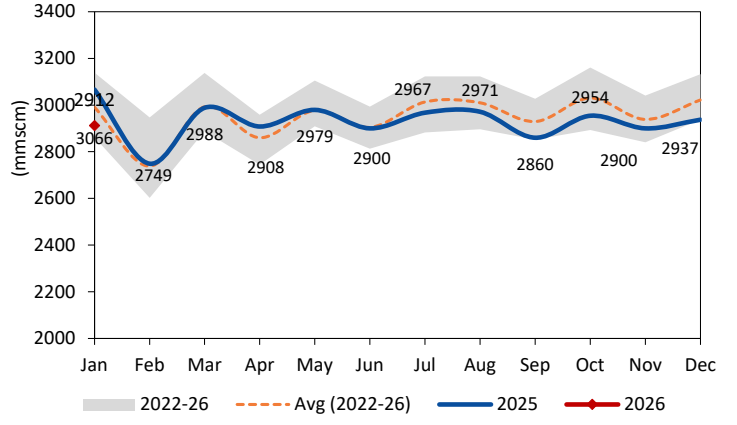
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 29: India's LNG volume down 7.2% MoM



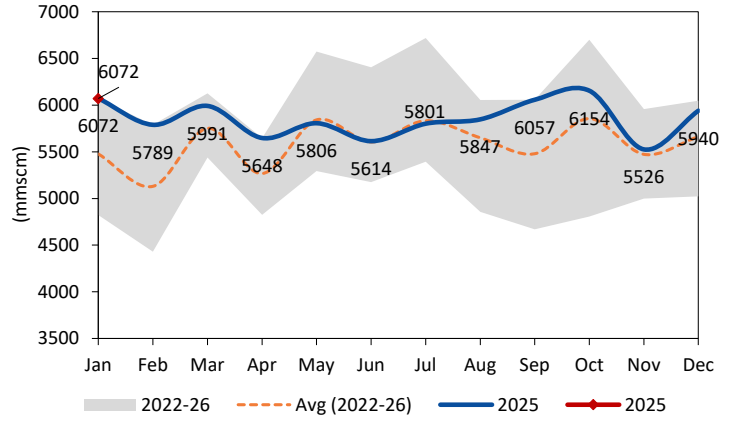
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 30: Domestic gas production remained volatile



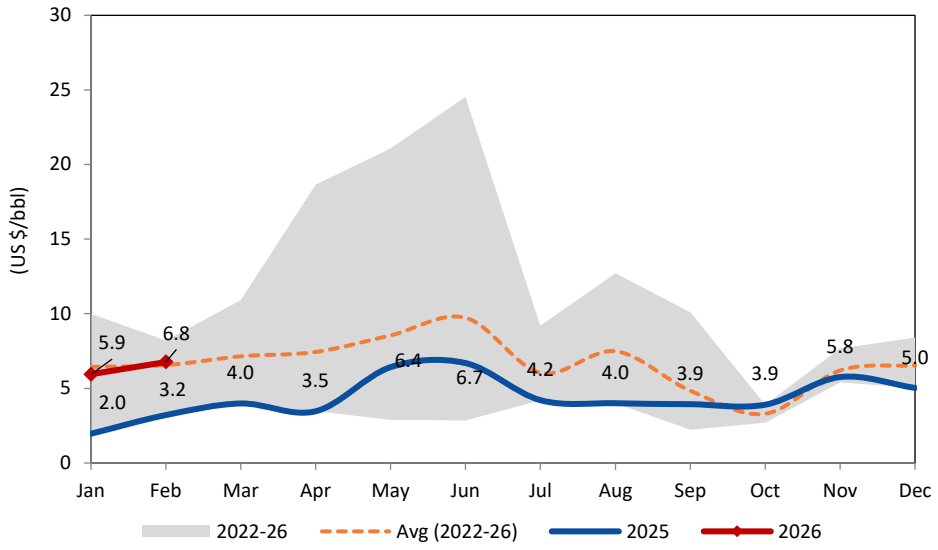
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 31: Total gas consumption down 4% MoM/7.4% in last 3m



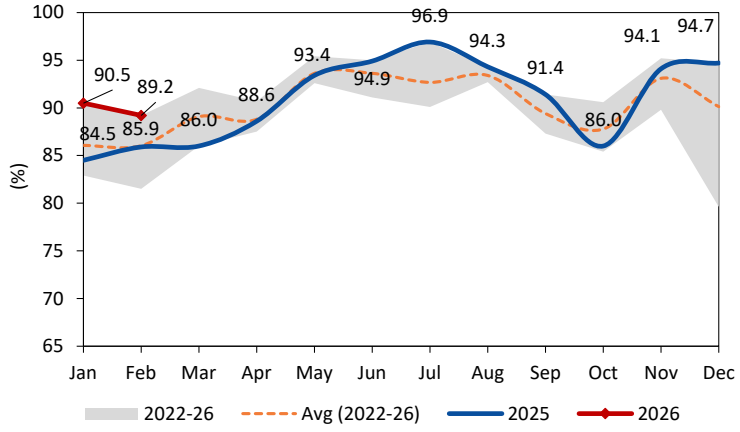
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 32: Benchmark GRM jumps 14% MoM/110% YoY (Brent: $70/bbl vs $75 YoY)



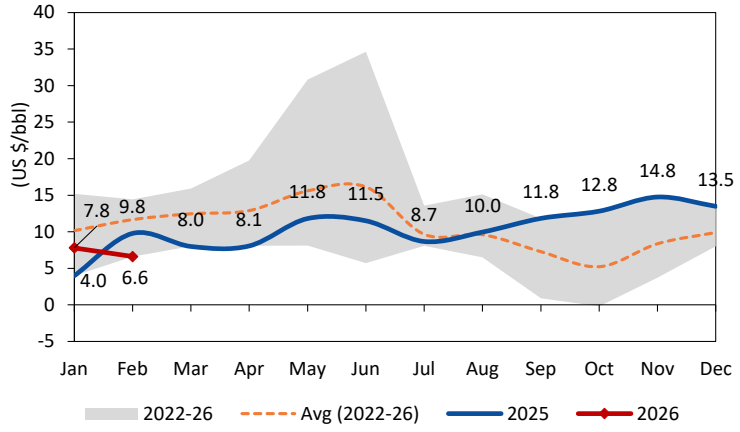
Source: Systematix Research

Exhibit 33: US refinery utilization at 89% in Feb (vs 86% Feb'25)



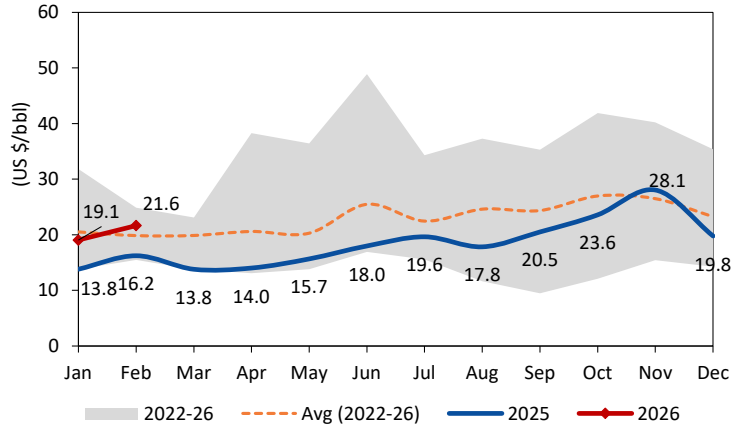
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 34: Gasoline cracks down 15%, now at $6.6/bbl, -32% YoY



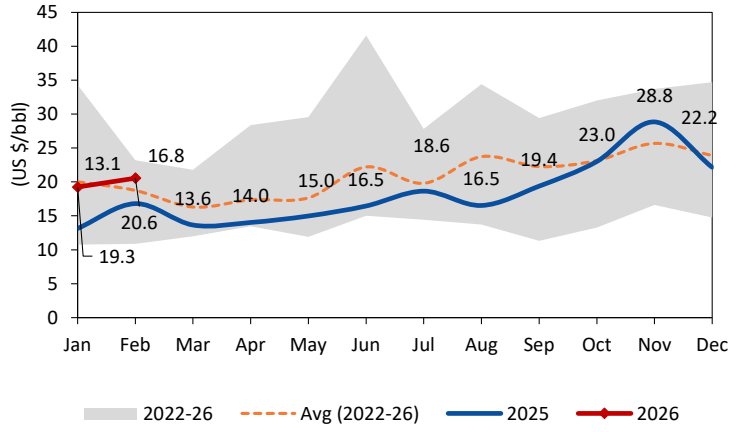
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 35: Gasoil cracks jumped 13.6% MoM to $21.6/bbl



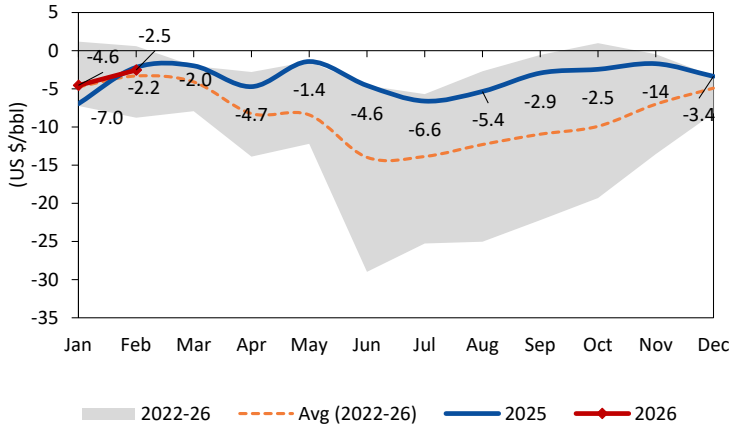
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 36: Jet-Kero crack spread up 6.7% MoM to $1.3/bbl



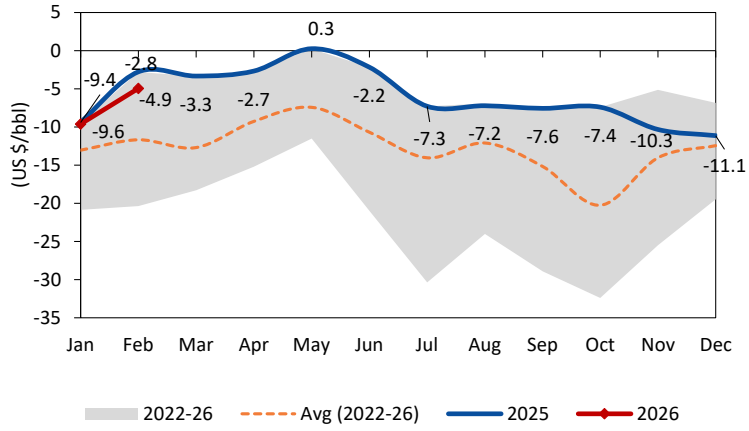
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 37: Naphtha crack remains volatile, now at $ -2.5/bbl



Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 38: Volatility persists in the fuel oil crack as well

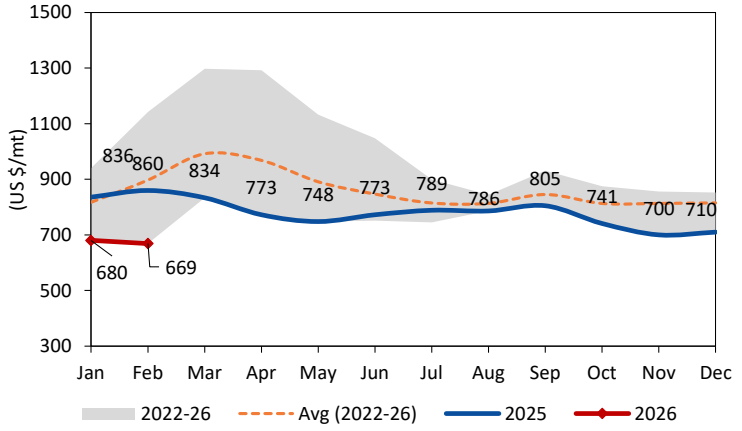


Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

India's refining capacity set for major expansion amid rising energy needs: As per PPAC, India ranks 4th in refining hubs in the world, with 23 refineries having combined 5.2 mbpd capacity, and is a net exporter of the refined products. However, the demand for fuels is expected to rise steadily. Over the past decade, domestic refining capacity has expanded by about 10%, while on a global scale, refining capacity currently stands at 104.5 mbpd, with more than 1 kbpd added in 2024 alone. Looking forward, India's primary energy demand is projected to grow at an average rate of ~3% p.a. until 2050, compared with the average global growth rate of <1% p.a. India also aspires to remain a net exporter. To meet this demand, the country is planning to add capacity: One 9 mmtpa refinery (HRRL) is currently in the final stages of construction in the Thar Desert at Pachpadra in the Balotra district of Rajasthan. Another similar capacity refinery is coming up at the site of an earlier old small refinery at Cauvery Basin. Many other existing refineries are undertaking expansion-cum-modernizaon projects. These green and brown addions total up to 55.6mmtpa and take the country's refining capacity to 309.5mmtpa by 2030. Two more refineries have been announced recently to keep pace with future demand.

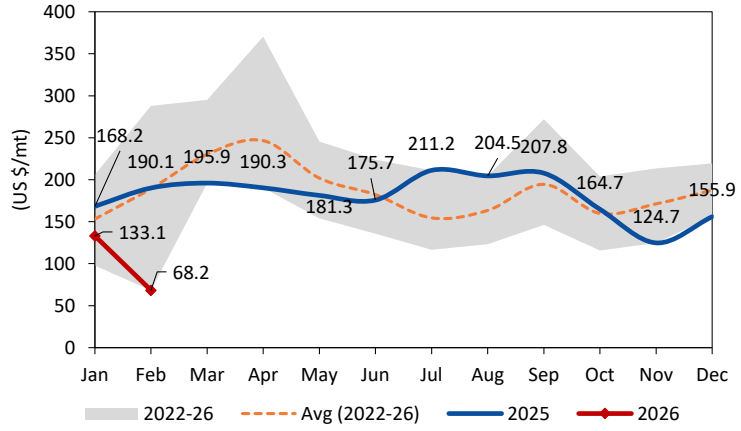
In Feb'26, ethylene prices remained flattish MoM but remain 22.2% lower YoY, while the ethylene–naphtha spread down 49% MoM/-64.1% YoY. HDPE prices up 2.7% MoM to $900/mt, with HDPE–naphtha spreads down 9% MoM/-4.2% YoY. PP prices rose 5.2% MoM but down 5.9% YoY at $878/mt, with PP–propylene spreads down 5% MoM to $66.6/mt. Fiber intermediates were mixed — MEG prices edged -3% MoM while down 11.8% YTD, while PTA jumped 1.1% MoM to $670/mt. Refining margins diverged as diesel GMM down 40% YoY/-57% MoM to Rs3.5/ltr on rise in crude prices (7.8% MoM), while petrol GMM down 10% MoM to Rs11.5/ltr.

Exhibit 39: Ethylene price flattish MoM/-22.2% YoY



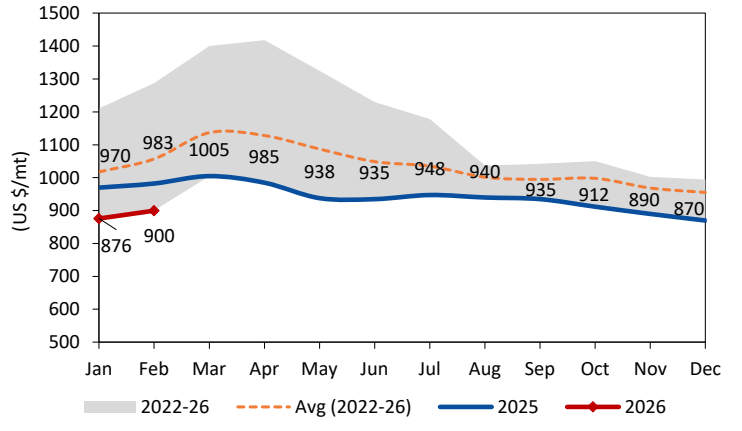
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 40: Ethylene-Naphtha down 49% MoM/down 64% YoY



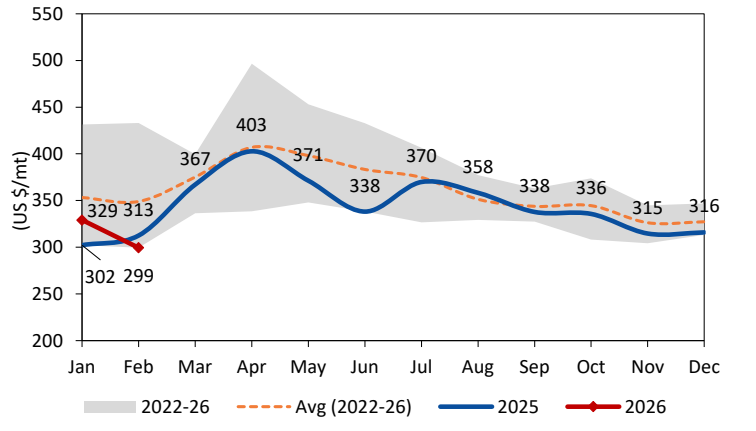
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 41: HDPE price up 2.7% MoM to $900/mt



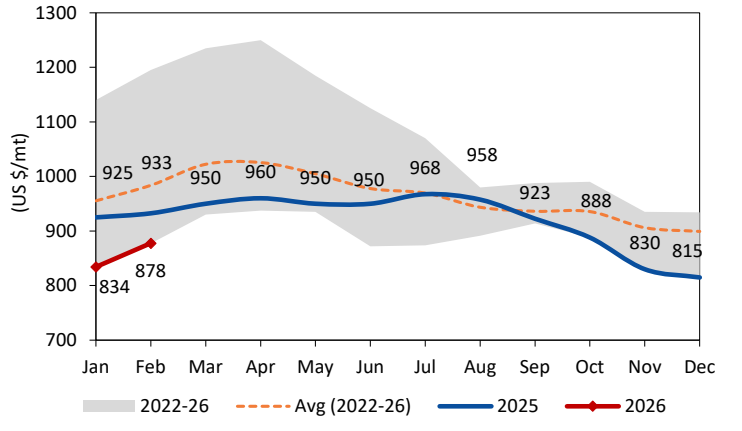
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 42: HDPE-Naphtha spread down 9% MoM/-4% YoY



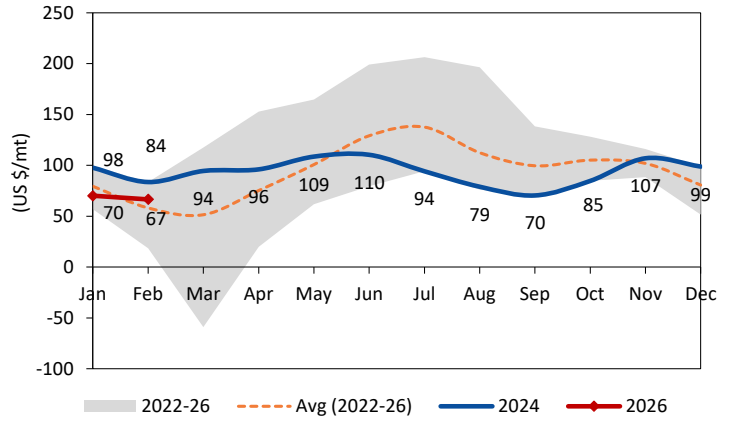
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 43: PP price down 5.9% YoY/+5.2% QoQ now at $878/mt



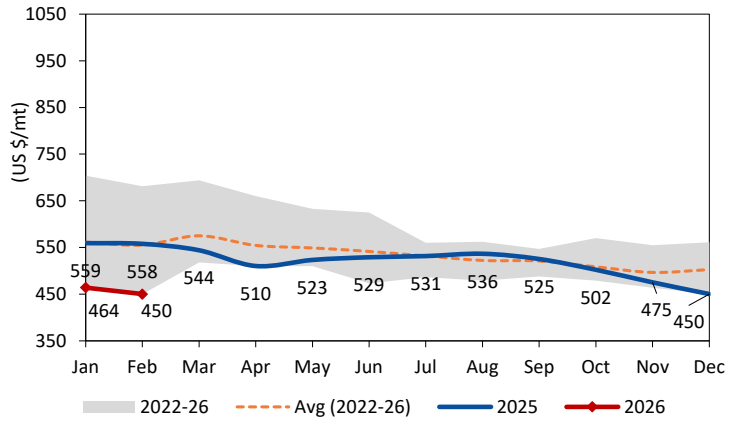
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 44: PP-P spread down 5% MoM to USD 67/mt



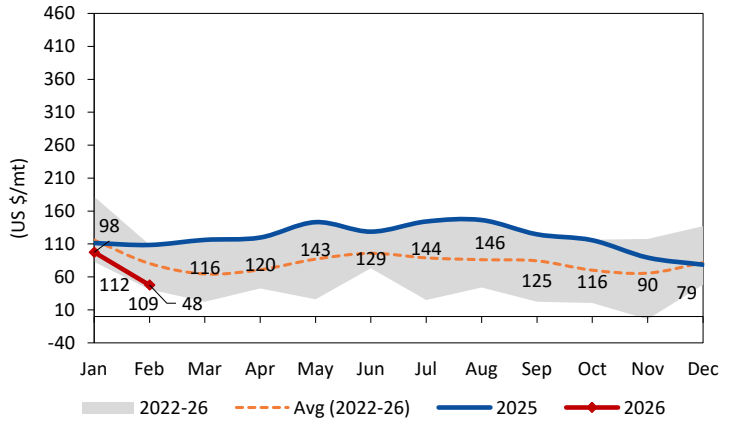
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 45: MEG price down 3% MoM/-16.1% YoY



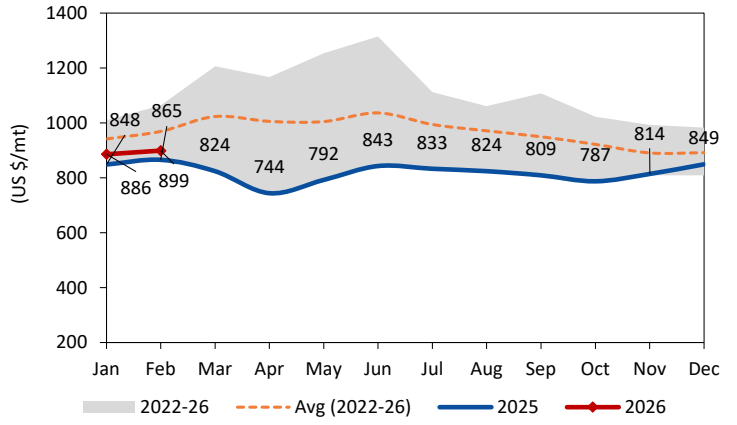
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 46: MEG-Naphtha spread down 51% MoM at $47.6/mt



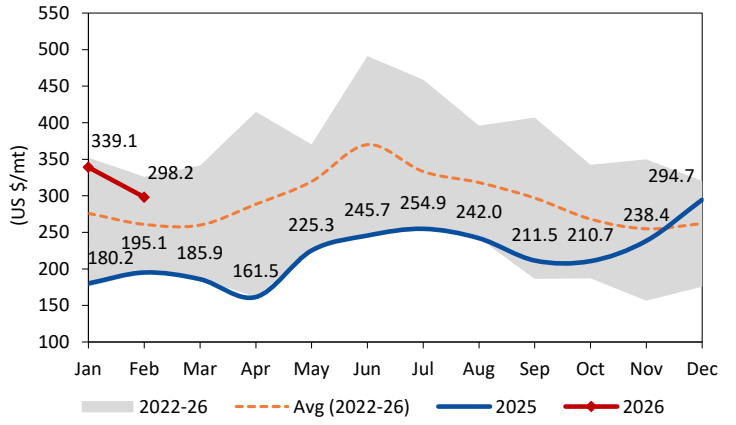
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 47: Px price -1% MoM/up 3.9% now at USD 898/mt



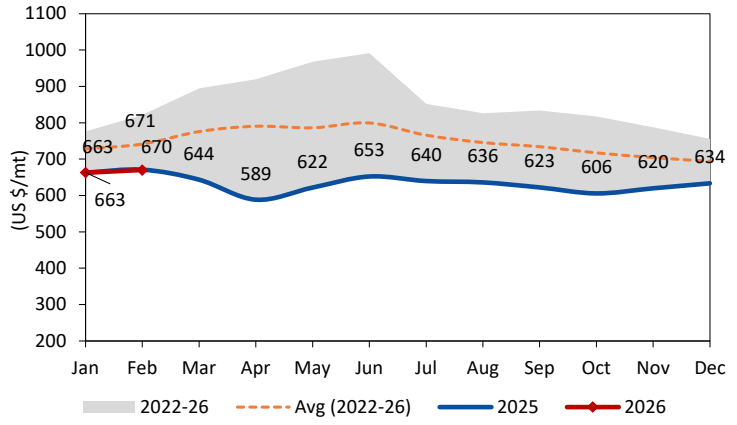
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 48: Px-Naphtha spread down 12% MoM (+53% YoY)



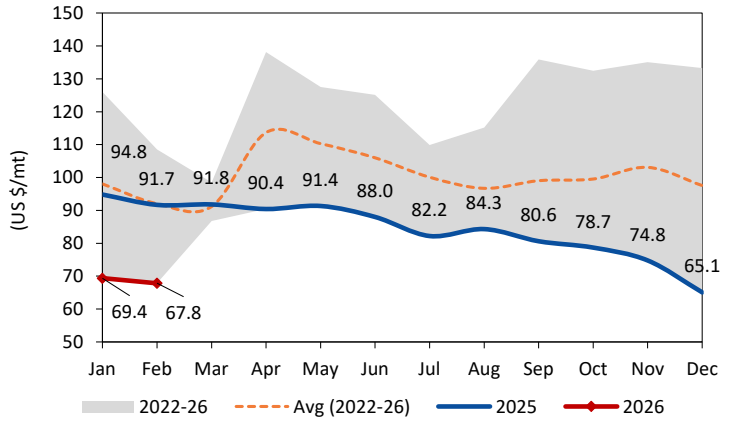
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 49: PTA price up 1.1% MoM now at $670/mt



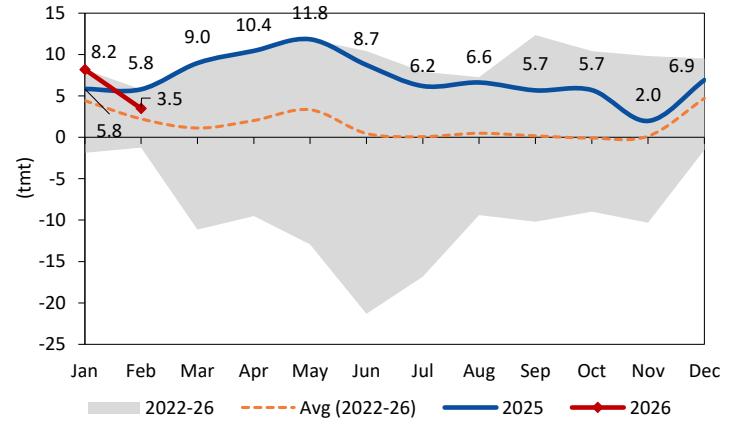
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 50: PTA-Px spread up 2.2% MoM to USD 67.8/mt



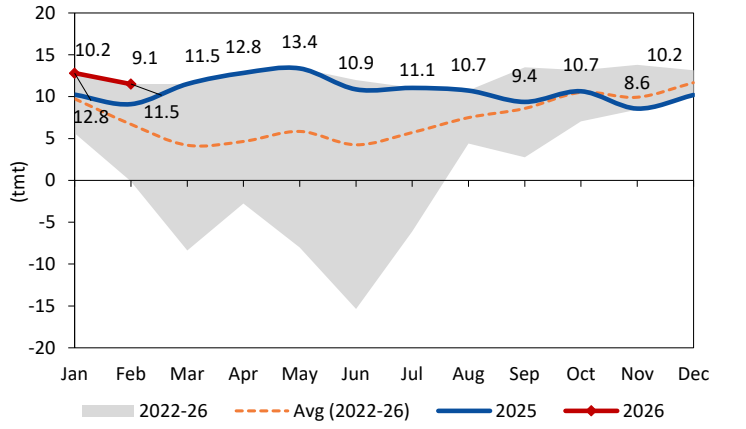
Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

Exhibit 51: Diesel GMM down 57% MoM/-39.9% YoY, to Rs 3.5/ltr



Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

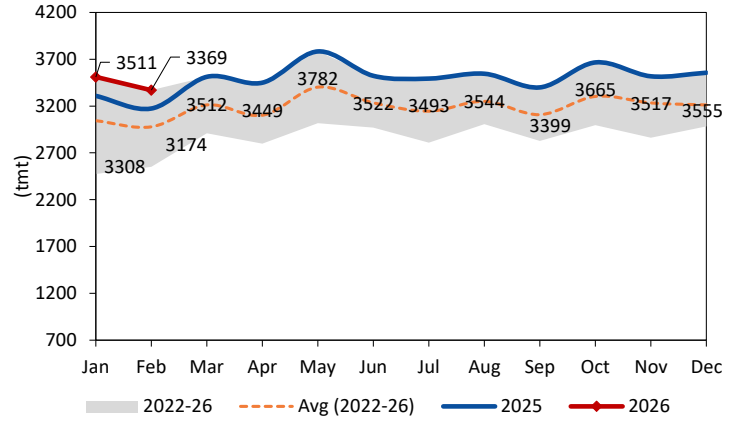
Exhibit 52: Petrol GMM -10% MoM to Rs11.5/ltr as crude jumps



Source: Bloomberg, Systematix Research

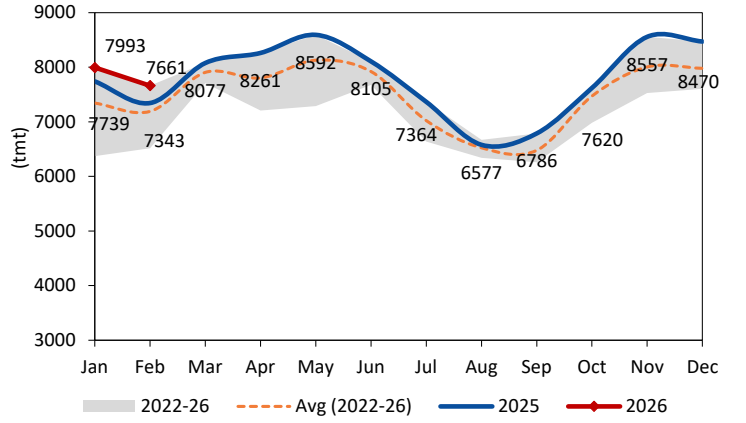
Petroleum products consumption – Feb'26: Total consumption stood at 20.2mmt, up 5.8% YoY/down 3.8% MoM. The YoY growth indicates a modest improvement, led by HSD, MS and LPG signaling ongoing infrastructure activity and industrial demand resilience, the sequential decline was largely driven by diesel, ATF, LPG and industrial fuels (FO/LSHS). LPG demand was up 9.7% YoY, the growth suggests steady rural and urban household usage, partly supported by subsidy schemes. Personal mobility demand remained strong, aided by travelling activities and stable fuel prices, MS consumption grew 6.1% YoY/-4% MoM. In HSD, sequential drop of 4.1% is due to lower freight movement. Bitumen's sharp 10.7% YoY/15.7% MoM jump reflects strong road construction activity under infrastructure push. We forecast summer holidays to support MS/HSD and LPG demand in coming months, while industrial production may recover further.

Exhibit 53: Gasoline consumption down 4% MoM/up 6% YoY



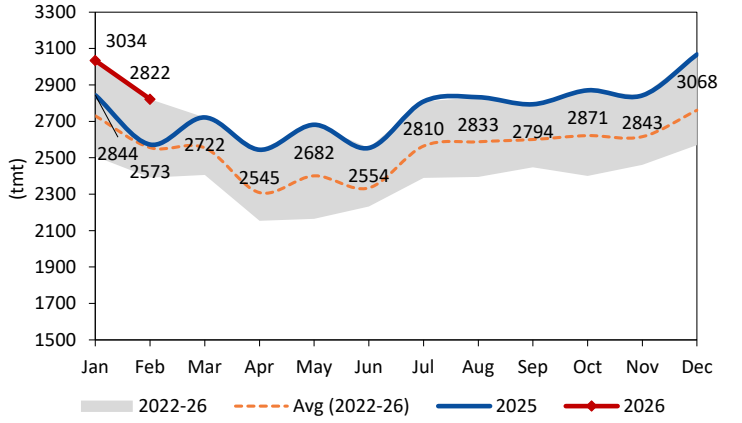
Source: PPAC, Systematix Research

Exhibit 54: …Gasoil consumption declines 4.1% MoM/+4.3% YoY



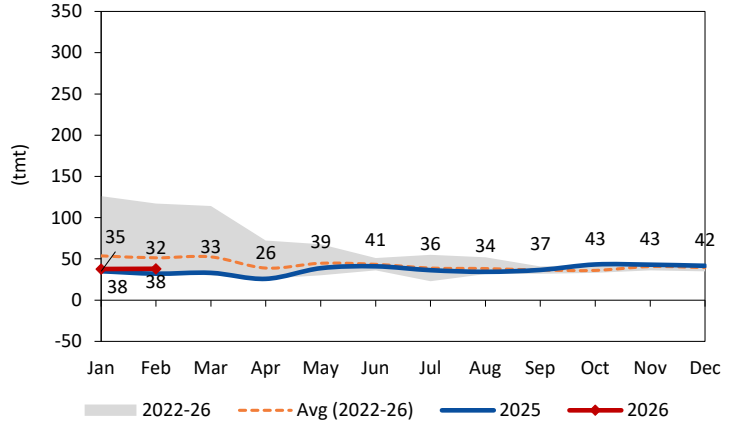
Source: PPAC, Systematix Research

Exhibit 55: LPG consumption down 7% MoM/9.7% YoY



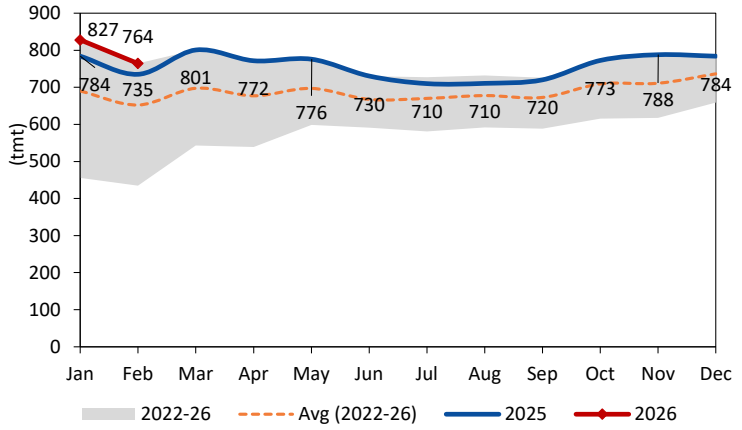
Source: PPAC, Systematix Research

Exhibit 56: SKO consumption flattish MoM/up 18% YoY



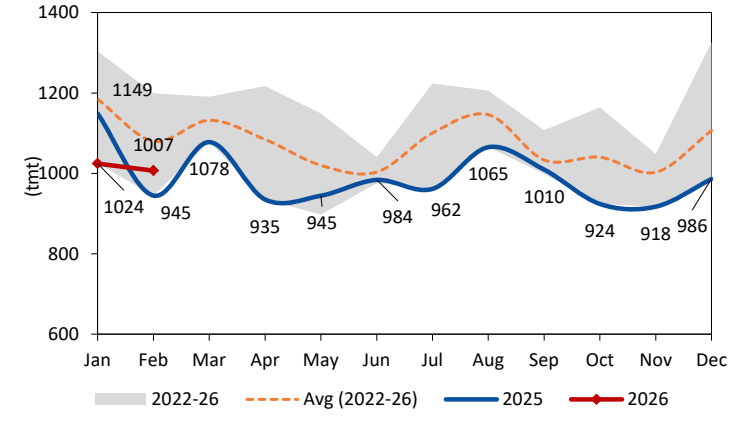
Source: PPAC, Systematix Research

Exhibit 57: ATF consumption slide 7.6% MoM while up 4% YoY



Source: PPAC, Systematix Research

Exhibit 58: Naphtha consumption jumps 6% YoY/down 1.7% QoQ



Source: PPAC, Systematix Research

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Served as an officer, director or employee	No

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